

## iPad2 rumours

A Chinese source states that the iPad 2 will be slimmer and have the 9.7-inch display with rear facing speakers



## Body Browser

Google's new tool, the Body Browser, gives you a 3D view of the human body, allowing zooming into the body as well

**Web awards**

specific achievements and challenges, rate others' games and artworks, and create your games; then watch as your name rises up the ranks and badges/quests flood your profile – a thrill that tempts nearly everyone. Apart from just your level/reputation, you also earn other rewards, such as collectable cards in the Kongai multiplayer game, which is described by one of the administrators as "Card-based tag-team, rock-paper scissors Street Fighter with +10 awesomeness 5/5."

Often, Kongregate also organises sweepstakes, allowing users to win prizes such as game DVDs and consoles by earning the correct badge, and taking part in the lucky draw.

The site features only free games, but just like free-to-play MMO portals, also offers virtual currency for in-game on-site micro-transactions, and these are called Kreds. While only some games support the purchasing of abilities and items, users can also donate Kreds to developers in their tip jars, contributing to the developer's further progress. There are numerous payment methods avail-

able for users to purchase Kreds, from PayPal to pre-paid cards and credit cards.

Another unique addition to Kongregate's offerings is the Art and Sounds section, something that you won't find elsewhere apart from game developer forums. The section helps artists show off their work, and collaborate with game developers in creating games. As mentioned earlier, these artworks can also be rated by users, a task that has the incentive of levelling up.

Like most of the other gaming portals, Kongregate also features user profiles and the ability for everyone to view them, though its offerings are a bit more detailed than others. Viewers will also be able to see which games which user has chosen as favourites, see the badges and cards they have earned, as well as the games they have created. Users can also share levels (from an in-game level editor) that they have created with other users. Apart from all this, users can 'friend' other users, or become their fans, allowing them to leave comments on each other's profile pages, and get updates.

## FIRST RUNNER-UP

### MiniClip.com

Miniclip.com, started in 2001 by the British duo Robert Small and Tihan Presbie, is one of the top gaming portals on the web today, pulling in more than £20 million in annual turnovers in recent years. The site has offered various other types content apart from just games to its users in the past, from TV shows to e-cards, and today, is also well-known for its quirky videos.

Overall, looking at everything from sheer variety, ease of navigation/discovery, load times, community strength and interactivity, game quality, browser compatibility and visual appeal, Kongregate is our Web Award winner for the Casual Gaming category, leading the runner-up by a substantial margin. The only negative points we can find about the site is the lack of a sitemap, and the inability to see all games across all categories listed alphabetically.

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Partial List

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